Keep your friends close, but your rights closer: **Social support and compliance with consent requests**



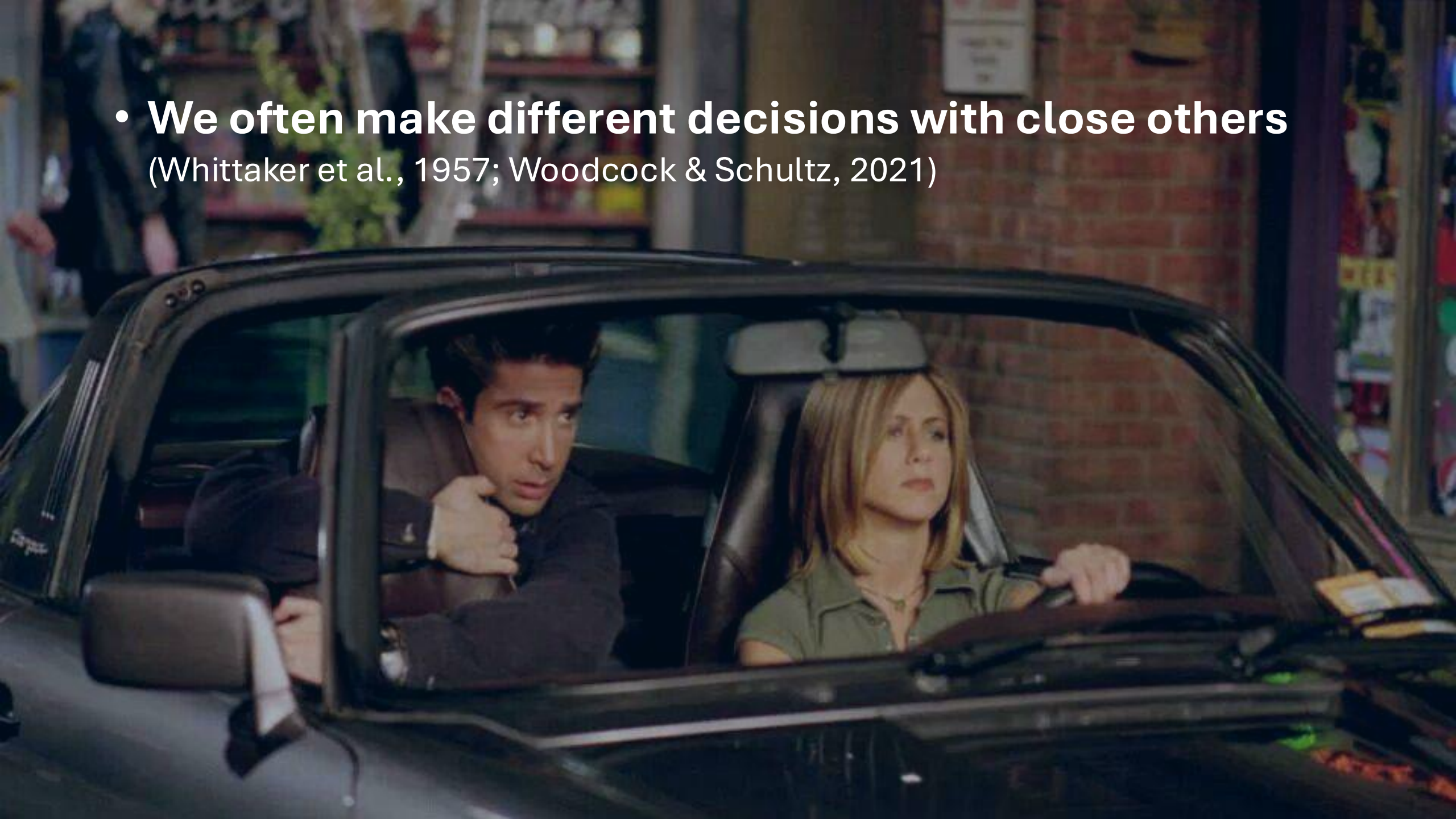
Helen Devine, B.S.

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- **90% of warrantless searches rely on compliance** with a request (Burke, 2015)
- When alone, people **overwhelmingly comply** (Sommers & Bohns, 2019)







- **We often make different decisions with close others**
  (Whittaker et al., 1957; Woodcock & Schultz, 2021)

Study 1: online, what do we *think* we'd do?

Imagine yourself…

ALONE

WITH A CLOSE FRIEND



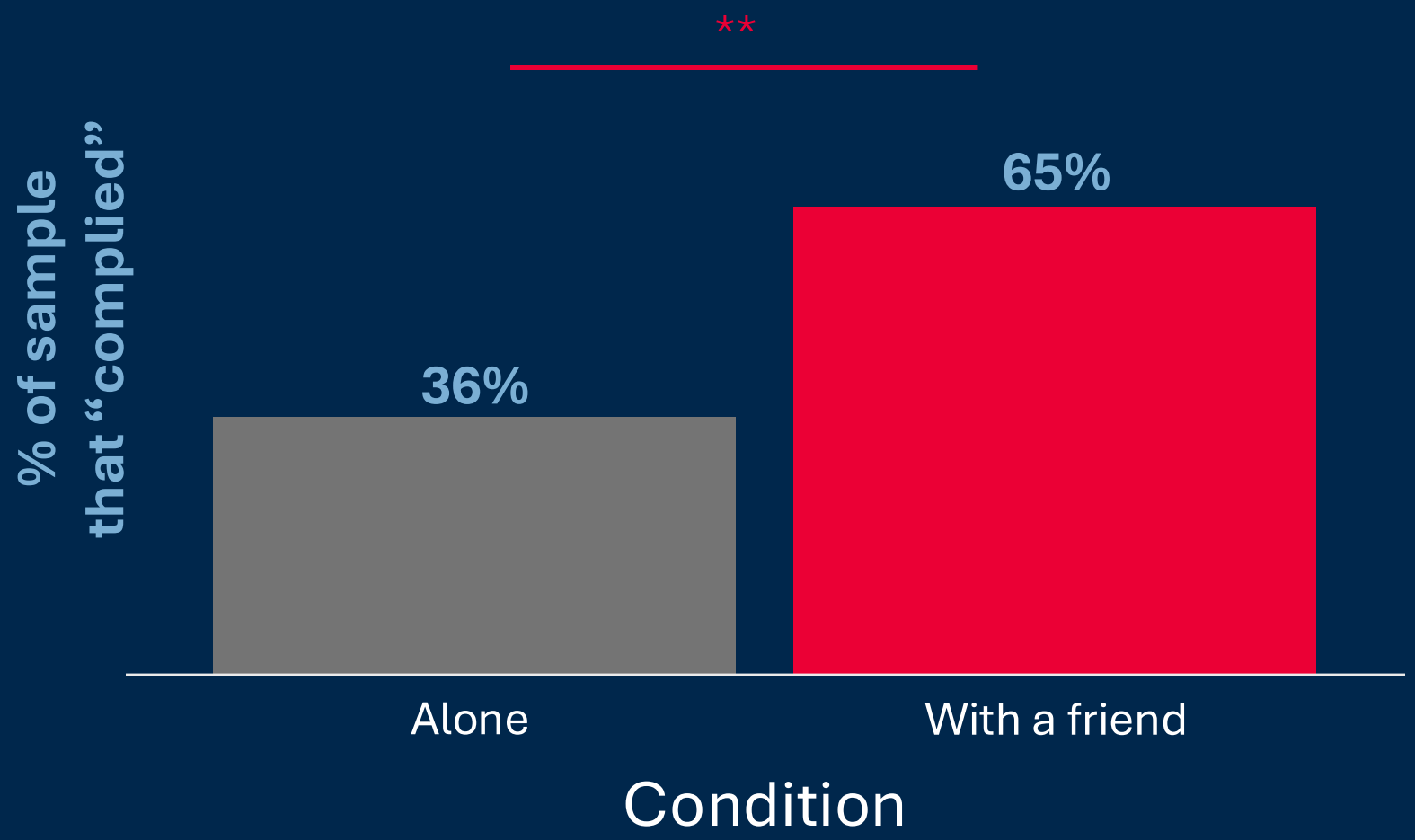
Would you unlock and hand over your phone?

"Before we begin the study, can you please unlock your phone and hand it to me?"

"I'll just need to take your phone outside of the room for a moment to check for some things."

***N* = 119 undergrads**, M_{age} = 18.8, SD_{age} = 1.05; 50.4% women; 50% white, 25% Asian, 18.5% Hispanic, 12.1% Black

Study 1: **online**, what do we *think* we'd do?

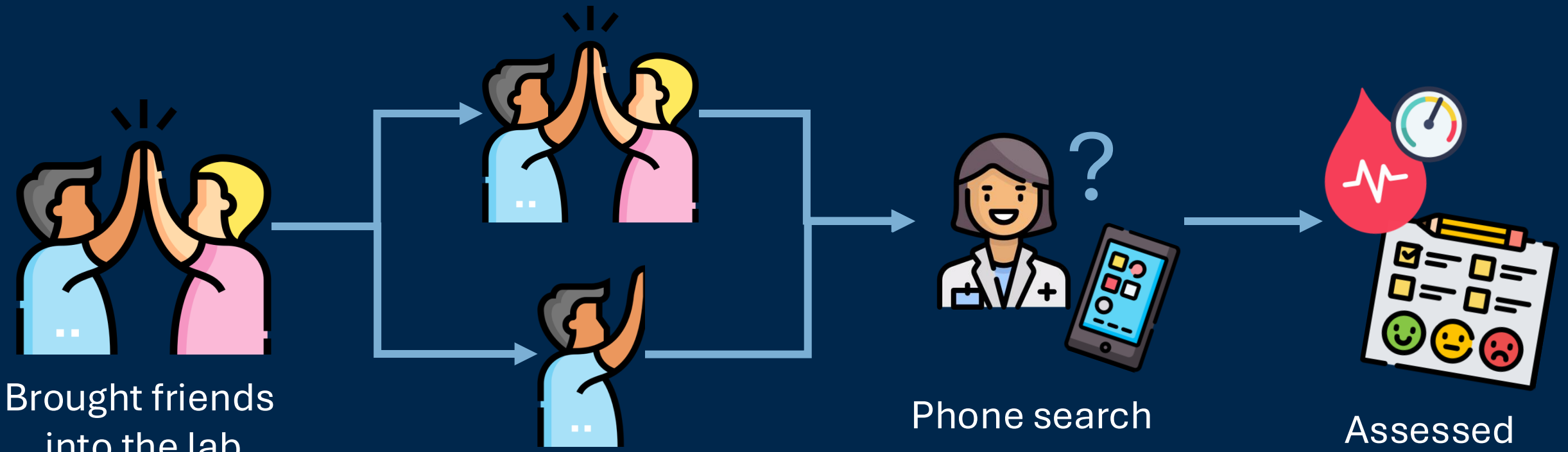


$X^2(1) = 9.15$, $p = 0.002$

Devine, Meyer, & Gordon, in prep

***N* = 119 undergrads**, M_{age} = 18.8, SD_{age} = 1.05; 50.4% women; 50% white, 25% Asian, 18.5% Hispanic, 12.1% Black

Study 2: in-lab, what do we *actually* do?



***N* = 253 undergrads** (**friend condition**, *n* = 99 pairs; **alone condition**, *n* = 55 individuals)
M_{age} = 19.64, SD_{age} = 2.22; 79.8% women; 59.7% white, 36% Asian, 10.3% Hispanic, 3.2% Black

Study 2: **in-lab**, what do we *actually* do?



Video censored for participants' privacy

Transcript:

Requester: *"Before we begin the study, can you please unlock your phone and hand it to me? I'll just need to take it outside of the room for a moment to check for some things."*

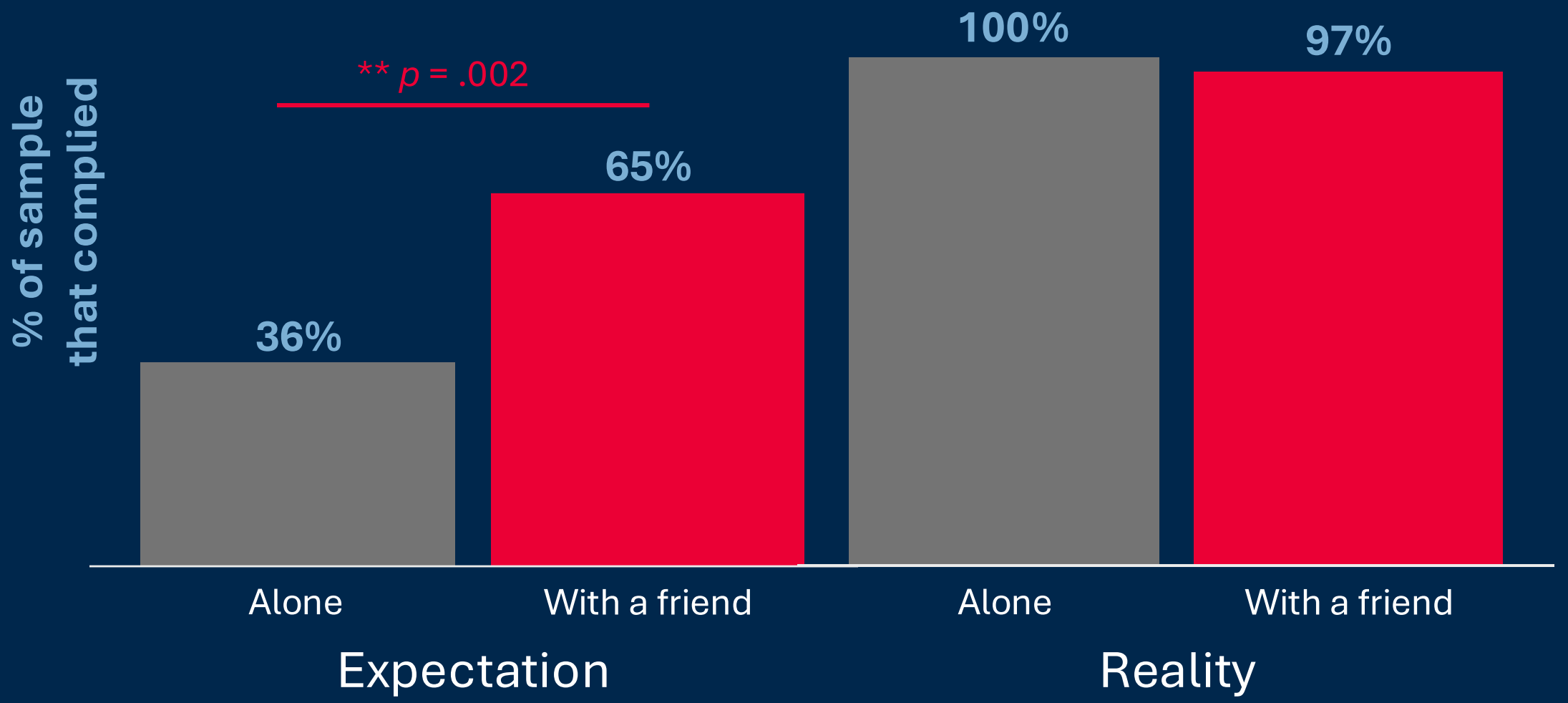
Bystander (after the requester leaves: *"Yo, what?"*

Target: *"Oh, they're doing it to make us nervous. That's what this is."*

Bystander: *"I would not have handed it to her. I'll be honest."*

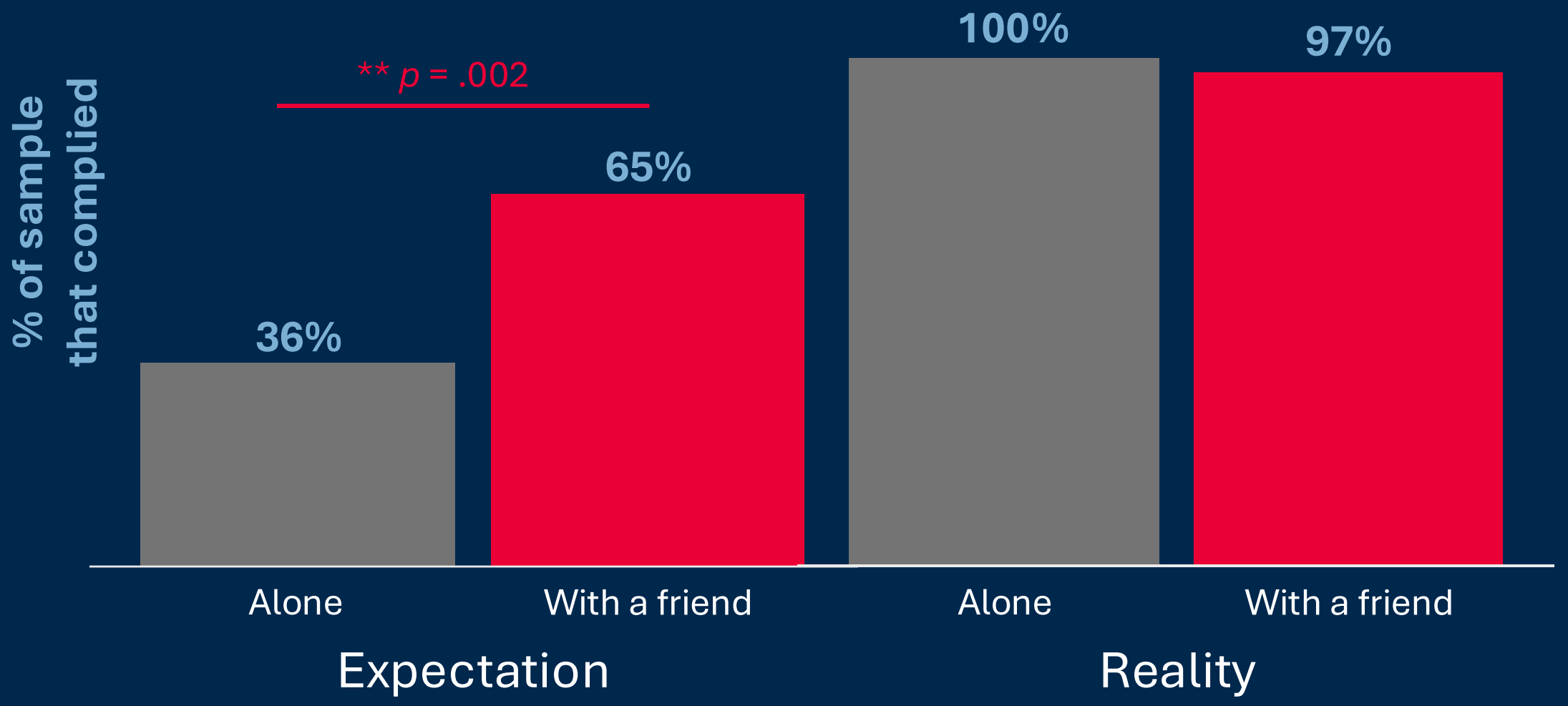
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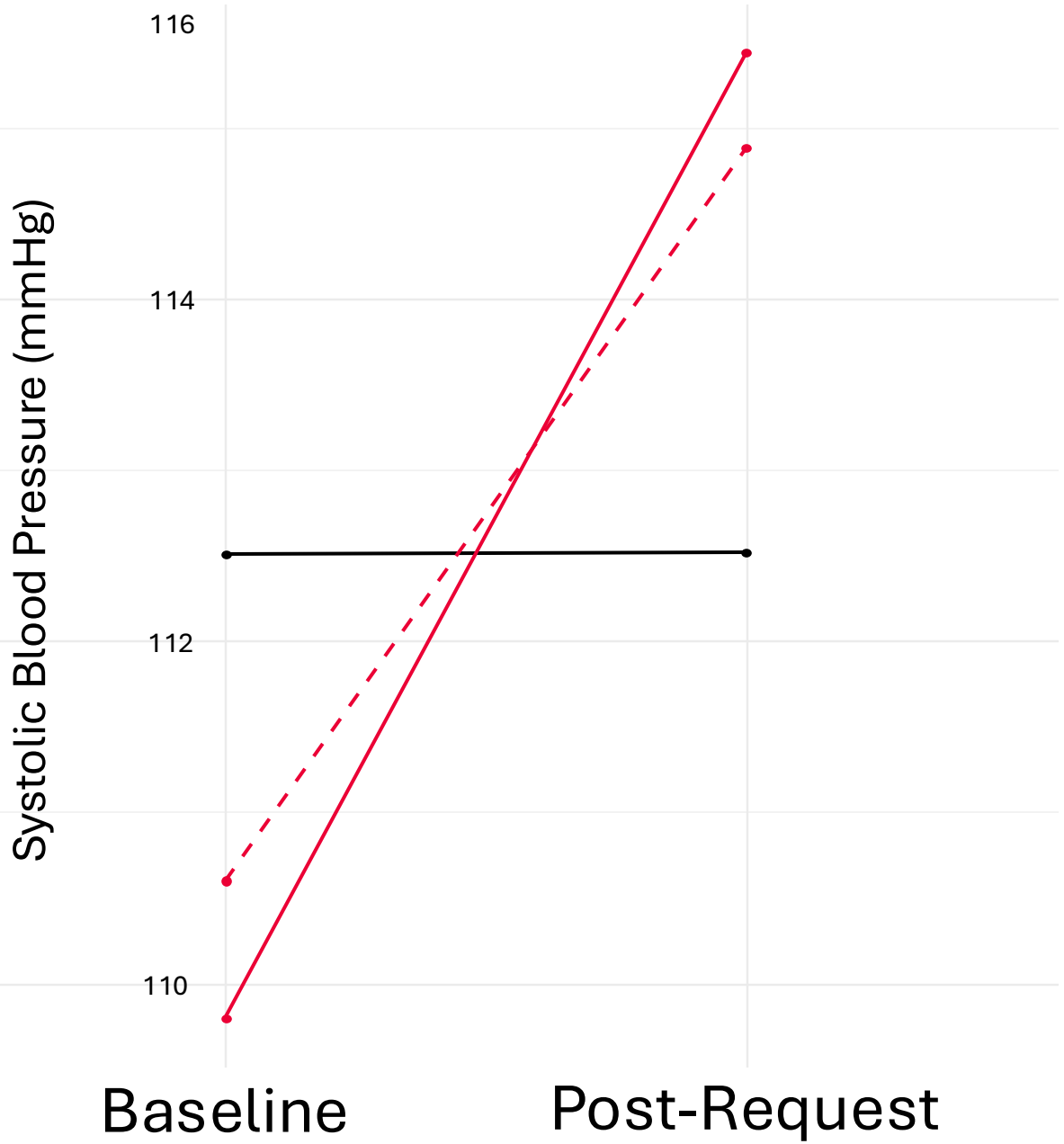


Devine, Meyer, & Gordon, in prep

People **underestimate** compliance across social situations, yet are **more accurate** when imagining themselves with a friend



Devine, Meyer, & Gordon, in prep



Alone

Friend: Target

Friend: Bystander

Alone: b = -1.19, p = .42

Target: b = -5.56, p < .0001

Bystander: b = -3.92, p < .0001

Interaction:
Friends: b = 4.38, p = .009
Bystanders: b = 2.73, p = .105



- Compliance when alone = compliance with a friend
- *Accuracy* of compliance expectations ↑ with a friend

Thank you!

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